

Outlook

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Follow-up: which service fails first under operating stress?

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

The resilience plan lists systems, but customers experience end-to-end services that cross ATM, card, transaction and communication processes. The timing also overlaps with Civil unrest and logistics disruption in KZN and Gauteng. Treat that as context to test, not an answer. Several teams are reporting more failed or retried activity than they expected, but they do not agree on the cause.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if cash access degrades before account servicing?
2. What evidence would instead support that manual workarounds create later reconciliation breaks?
3. How do we rule out that recovery restores authorisation before posting catches up?

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use July 2021 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. Please work towards the order in which critical services should be recovered and tested. A useful output would be a Power BI page with drill-through to a reproducible case list.

Use transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations. One caution: Treat this as a historical service-impact rehearsal, not proof of infrastructure capacity.

Regards